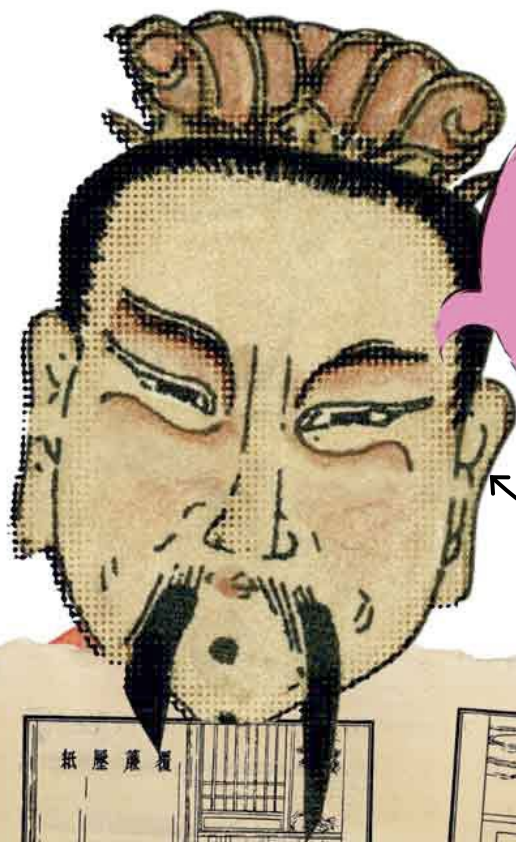




By the way...

My special papermaking recipe included tree bark, fibers from the bamboo plant, some silk rags I had lying around, and even old fishing nets.

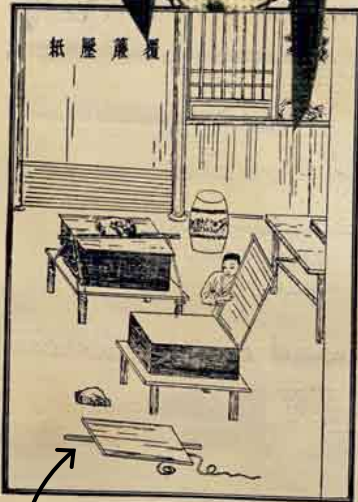
Ts'ai Lun was a court official during the Han Dynasty.

How it changed the world

Paper made information, stories, and ideas storable on a light, strong, cheap, and space-saving surface. Without it, the printing press would never have made books and reading so popular.

Making paper

The papermaking process **HASN'T CHANGED MUCH** since Ts'ai Lun's time. Plant or textile fibers are still mashed up into a pulp, which is then sieved to create a wet sheet, and then pressed to dry it. The main difference is that **machines do it for us these days**—the first papermaking machine was invented in 1798. Also, in the 19th century, paper began to be made from wood pulp, which made it cheap enough to get **almost everyone scribbling**.



The pulp is pressed to squeeze the water out, leaving a sheet of paper.



The paper is fully dried by hanging it up on a wall.

Did you know?

Ts'ai Lun's discovery made him very famous and wealthy in China, and helped spread Chinese culture far and wide.

TEA BAGS first went on sale in 1903. At first, they were made from **SILK**, but now they're made from paper.

PAPER TISSUES were made available in the 1920s and gradually replaced **CLOTH HANDKERCHIEFS**.